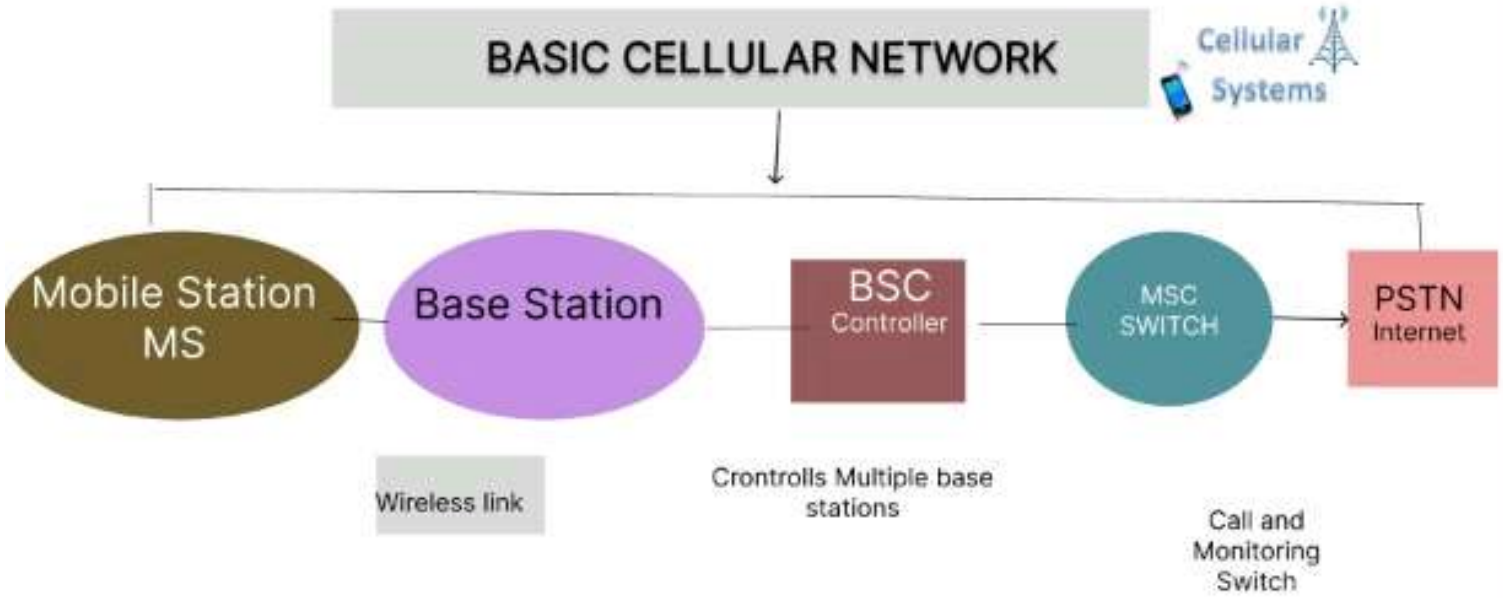
BASIC CELLULAR NETWORK
Cellular
Systems
Mobile Station
MS
Base Station
BSC
Controller
MSC
SWITCH
PSTN
Internet
Wireless link
Crontrolls Multiple base
stations
Call and
Monitoring
Switch

A basic cellular network

NETWORK FUNDAMENTALS

An introductory field guide

How a cellular network connects you

Your phone's wireless hop is just the beginning. A shared network carries your data and calls the rest of the way.

01 One journey, four parts

Traffic flows in both directions

Mobile phones
Send and receive calls and data over a wireless radio link.

Base stations
Provide radio access and serve phones within their coverage.

Backhaul → core
Backhaul transports traffic to the core, which manages and routes it.

Other networks
Reach websites, online services or people on telephone networks.

Wireless radio — Transport / network connection

Intermediate equipment and voice-service systems omitted for clarity.